

FEATURE BIBLE / VERSION 1.0

TAM REACTION SYSTEM

Curated, collectible in-match expression for sportsmanship, playful rivalry, hero personality, Infinity discoveries, ranked status, and live content - without text chat or gameplay advantage.

FIVE EQUIPPED

FAST MATCH ACCESS

MUTE-FIRST SAFETY

DON'T WATCH MEDIA / JULY 2026

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Document Control

This reference preserves the complete supplied Reaction System design and adds an explicitly labeled production handoff. Candidate values remain tunable until validated in prototype and competitive testing.

DOCUMENT STATUS	CANDIDATE - approved for implementation planning
IMPLEMENTATION EVIDENCE	NOT STARTED - no reaction inventory, loadout, wheel, network event, or mute control is present in the current website evidence
PRODUCT SURFACE	Competitive TAM with shared profile, economy, ranked, seasonal, achievement, character mastery, event, and Infinity Taps acquisition sources
CORE CONTRACT	Five equipped reactions, fast in-match access, curated TAM-authored content, expressive animation, robust mute controls, and zero gameplay advantage
SOURCE	Reaction System feature brief supplied by Don't Watch Media

Reading the Status

CANDIDATE means the feature direction is accepted for implementation planning, while exact cooldowns, caps, animation budgets, rarity values, duplicate conversion, and saved loadouts remain subject to decision and testing. NOT STARTED describes implementation evidence, not design quality.

Reaction System Specification

This fits Tap Against Me extremely well. Matches are short, visually expressive, and competitive, so reactions give players personality without requiring voice or text chat.

Core Interaction

Each player owns a collection of animated emoji-style reactions and equips five reactions through their profile.

During a match, the player presses a reaction icon to open a compact five-slot reaction wheel. Sliding or tapping selects the reaction, which then appears near their character, profile banner, or side of the screen for roughly 1.5-2 seconds.

The five equipped reactions become the player's personal communication loadout.

Examples include:

- Laughing or playful taunts
- "Too easy"
- Shocked face
- Sweating or nervous reaction
- Angry reaction
- Applause
- Good game
- Close call
- Crown or victory pose
- Sleeping or bored reaction
- "Come on!"
- Friendly encouragement
- Character-specific reactions

How Players Obtain Them

Reactions should come from several systems so the collection feels meaningful:

Source	Purpose
Coin shop	Gives coins another cosmetic use
Achievement rewards	Marks accomplishments

Source	Purpose
Competitive ranks	Shows skill or seasonal status
Seasonal progression	Creates limited-time collectibles
Infinity Taps discoveries	Rewards exploration and casual play
Secret interactions	Encourages experimentation
Events and challenges	Supports recurring content
Character mastery	Deepens attachment to owned heroes

Some Infinity Taps reactions should be exclusive to Infinity Taps and unavailable for direct purchase. For example, repeatedly tapping a hidden frog might unlock a frog-laugh reaction, or discovering a sleeping hero might unlock a sleeping emoji.

Reaction Categories

The collection menu could organize reactions into:

- Friendly: applause, heart, thumbs-up, good game
- Competitive: crown, challenge, "bring it," confident grin
- Taunts: laughing, sleeping, tiny violin, missed-me
- Emotional: shocked, angry, crying, nervous
- Hero reactions: animated faces based on TAM characters
- World discoveries: animals, plants, weather, biome icons
- Ranked rewards: Bronze through top-tier seasonal reactions
- Limited and secret: rare discoveries or event rewards

Animation and Presentation

These should feel more alive than ordinary phone emojis. They can include:

- Facial animation
- Small particles
- Sound effects
- Brief text or symbols
- Character-specific movements
- Entrance and exit animations
- Rare reaction variants

For example, a laughing reaction might bounce while releasing small tears, while a legendary crown reaction could briefly place a glowing crown over the player's hero.

Animations must remain lightweight and should never obstruct the play area, hide hazards, or interfere with tapping.

Anti-Spam Protection

Taunting is fun until it becomes constant screen clutter. I would implement:

- Approximately a 3-second cooldown between reactions
- A maximum number of reactions within a rolling time window
- Automatic suppression when repeatedly selecting the same reaction
- A setting to mute opponent reactions
- A separate option to disable reaction sounds
- No gameplay advantage or input interruption

The player should still be able to use their own reactions when opponents are muted.

Competitive Match Behavior

Reactions could appear:

- Before the countdown
- During active play
- Immediately after a player makes a mistake
- When someone obtains an item or power-up
- During the match result screen

A reaction sent during the final few seconds could remain visible briefly on the results screen, allowing players to celebrate, acknowledge a close match, or taunt after winning.

The system should avoid unrestricted player-uploaded images at launch. TAM-created reactions provide the feeling of customization while preventing offensive imagery, copyright problems, and substantial moderation requirements.

Profile Integration

The profile should contain:

- Reaction collection
- Five equipped slots
- Rarity and source information
- Locked reaction previews
- Favorite reaction

- Total reactions owned
- Recently unlocked reactions
- Filters by category, rarity, season, and source

Players could eventually save different loadouts, such as:

- Friendly loadout
- Competitive loadout
- Infinity Taps loadout
- Hero-themed loadout

Economy and Rarity

Possible tiers:

- Common
- Uncommon
- Rare
- Epic
- Legendary
- Secret

Coin prices should reflect presentation quality rather than competitive value. A simple static reaction might be inexpensive, while an animated hero reaction with particles and sound may cost substantially more.

Duplicates should not clutter inventories. Duplicate rewards could convert into coins, reaction fragments, or cosmetic crafting currency.

IMPORTANT DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Reactions should support both sportsmanship and playful rivalry. TAM should allow players to tease each other, but it should not require text chat or create an environment where harassment becomes part of normal play.

The strongest implementation is a curated, collectible reaction system with five equipped reactions, fast in-match access, expressive animation, Infinity Taps discoveries, ranked rewards, and robust mute controls.

Production Handoff

The following plan is a working delivery sequence derived from the supplied feature brief. It does not silently lock candidate values; each gate converts design intent into testable evidence.

Recommended Delivery Phases

0	Decision lock	Confirm reaction taxonomy, five-slot input pattern, cooldown/window values, match moments, rarity language, duplicate policy, and exact moderation boundary.
1	Profile and data foundation	Create reaction definitions, ownership, acquisition source, rarity, preview, favorite, five equipped slots, persistence, source provenance, and migration rules.
2	In-match vertical slice	Implement the compact wheel, slide/tap selection, character-side presentation, 1.5-2 second lifetime, one friendly reaction, one taunt, one hero reaction, and result-screen carryover.
3	Network trust and safety	Add authoritative send validation, approximately three-second cooldown, rolling-window cap, repeated-selection suppression, opponent mute, sound mute, replay/spectator policy, and abuse telemetry.
4	Acquisition integration	Connect coin shop, achievements, ranked seasons, events, challenges, character mastery, secret interactions, and Infinity-exclusive discoveries without duplicating one-time grants.
5	Polish and live content	Add richer animation, particles, sounds, rare variants, category/source filters, locked previews, recent unlocks, saved loadout candidates, analytics, accessibility, and seasonal authoring tools.

Canonical Data Fields

- Reaction definition: reaction_id, display_name, category, rarity, animation_key, sound_key, duration_ms, source_class, source_reference, purchasable, price, season_id, hero_compatibility, tags, active.
- Player ownership: player_id, reaction_id, source_class, source_reference, unlocked_at, favorite, seen, duplicate_conversion, grant_transaction_id.
- Loadout: player_id, slot_1 through slot_5, active_loadout_id, updated_at. Multiple saved loadouts remain post-MVP until explicitly approved.
- Match event: match_id, sender_id, reaction_id, sent_at_server_ms, match_phase, cooldown_state, suppression_reason, visible_to_opponent, carries_to_results.
- Preferences: mute_opponent_reactions, reaction_sound_enabled, own_reactions_enabled, reduced_reaction_motion, remote_reaction_density.

Required Analytics

- reaction_wheel_opened, reaction_selected, reaction_sent, reaction_suppressed, reaction_seen, opponent_reactions_muted, reaction_sound_muted
- reaction_unlocked, reaction_equipped, reaction_favorited, reaction_previewed, duplicate_reaction_converted
- Match context: countdown, active play, item event, mistake window, elimination, final seconds, or result screen
- Safety and quality: sends per match, repeated-reaction rate, mute rate, sound-mute rate, frame-time impact, input interruption reports, and obscured-gameplay reports

Release Acceptance

- A player can own reactions, equip exactly five valid unique slots, preview them, reorder them, and retain the loadout across sign-in and device restart.
- The compact wheel opens without pausing, covering critical information, stealing an unintended gameplay tap, or changing physics.
- A selected reaction appears in a protected presentation region for the authored duration and remains readable across supported portrait sizes.
- The server rejects unowned IDs, invalid match states, cooldown violations, rolling-window spam, duplicates, and malformed events without interrupting play.
- Opponent mute and sound mute work immediately; muting an opponent never prevents the local player from using or seeing their own reactions.
- Reaction animation, particles, sound, text, and symbols obey accessibility, flash, motion, density, and performance budgets.
- TAM-authored content is the only launch content path. No player-uploaded imagery, free text, or hidden communication channel enters the MVP.
- Infinity-exclusive, ranked, achievement, event, mastery, and secret grants preserve source provenance and cannot be directly purchased when marked earned-only.
- Reactions have no effect on tap force, input validation, gravity, collision, pickups, matchmaking, rating, rewards, or competitive outcomes.
- Two-device testing proves ordering, latency tolerance, reconnect behavior, final-seconds carryover, result-screen display, mute behavior, and replay policy.

FINAL PRINCIPLE

Reactions support sportsmanship and playful rivalry. They provide personality without requiring text chat and must never turn harassment, clutter, moderation debt, or competitive interference into normal play.